Mario Leccese

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Academic Appointments and Affiliations

University of Chicago, Booth School of Business 2026 -
Affiliate Fellow of the Stigler Center

Boston University, Questrom School of Business 2024 -
Assistant Professor in Strategy & Innovation

Education

University of Maryland

Ph.D., Economics 2024
Dissertation: "Essays on Competition and Innovation"
Committee: Ginger Zhe Jin, Andrew Sweeting,
Liad Wagman, Chenyu Yang and Rajshree Agarwal

M.A., Economics 2020

Bocconi University

M.Sc., Economics (DES) 2017
B.Sc., Economics (CLES) 2015

Research Interests

Industrial Organization, Strategy, Antitrust & Competition Policy, Economics of Innovation, Venture Capital & Entrepreneurship.

Publications

[1] Should We Expect Uncertain Synergies To Be Passed Through to Consumers? (with Andrew Sweeting and Xuezhen Tao). **The Journal of Industrial Economics**, Vol. 73(1), pp.1-30, 2025.

[2] Taxing Ride-sharing: Which Neighborhoods Pay More? **Journal of Regional Science**, Vol. 64(4), pp.1393-1413, 2024.

[3] M&A and Technological Expansion (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). **Journal of Economics & Management Strategy**, Vol. 3(2), pp. 338-359, 2024.

[4] How Do Top Acquirers Compare in Technology Mergers? New Evidence from an S&P Taxonomy (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). **International Journal of Industrial Organization**, Vol. 89, 2023.

[5] M&A and Innovation: A New Classification of Patents (with Zhaoqi Cheng, Ginger Zhe Jin, Dokyun Lee and Liad Wagman). **American Economic Association: Papers & Proceedings**, Vol. 113, pp. 288-293, May 2023.

Book Chapters

[6] The Role of Digital Platforms in Shaping Tech Venture Innovation (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). Chapter in the **Handbook on Digital Platforms**, edited by Anthony Dukes, D. Daniel Sokol, Tianshu Sun, and Feng Zhu, Cambridge University Press (forthcoming). Also available as NBER WP #33370.

Other Publications

[7] Public comments submitted to the EU Commission on the review of the Digital Markets Act (with Ginger Jin, Jorge Klinnert and Liad Wagman), September 2025.

[8] The Draft Merger Guidelines Risk Reducing Innovation (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). ProMarket, October 2023.

[9] Public comments submitted to the DOJ/FTC Request for Information regarding the Draft Merger Guidelines (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman), July 2023. Available at: https://www.regulations.gov/comment/FTC-2023-0043-1429.

[10] Asymmetric Taxation, Pass-through and Market Competition: Evidence from Ride-sharing and Taxis. Proceedings of the 2022 ACM Conference on Economics and Computation, 371–372. New York, NY, USA:Association for Computing Machinery.

[11] Public comments submitted to the DOJ/FTC Request for Information on Merger Enforcement (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman), March 2022. Available at: https://www.regulations.gov/comment/FTC-2022-0003-0138.

Working Papers

[1] The Effects of Targeted Platform Taxes: Evidence from Ride-sharing and Taxis. 2022. SSRN working paper #3824453. *Revise and Resubmit* at the Journal of Public Economics.

[2] Dynamic Seller Competition When Buyers Have Bargaining Power (with Shanglyu Deng, Calvin Jia and Andrew Sweeting). 2023. NBER working paper #32360: "Dynamic Competition with Bargaining." *Revise and Resubmit* at the Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics.

[3] The Signaling Value of Technology Venture Acquisitions (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). 2024. SSRN working paper #4943381. *Revise and Resubmit* at the Strategic Management Journal.

[4] Strategic Investment in Competitors: Theory and Evidence from Technology Startups. 2024. SSRN working paper #4968068.

[5] Hiding a Flaw? Experimental Evidence on Multi-Dimensional Information Disclosure (with Agata Farina). 2024. SSRN working paper #4785923.

[6] How Does Privacy Regulation Affect Transatlantic Venture Investment? Evidence from GDPR (with Jian Jia, Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). 2025. NBER working paper #33909. SSRN working paper #3436535.

[7] Serial Acquisitions in Tech (with Ginger Zhe Jin, Liad Wagman and Yunfei Wang). 2025. SSRN working paper #5392628. NBER working paper #34178. *Revise and Resubmit* at the Review of Economics and Statistics.

[8] The Hart-Scott-Rodino Act at Fifty: Acquisition Patterns and Industry Dynamics (with Ginger Jin, Daniel Sokol, Liad Wagman, and Mengyi Zhong), July 2026. SSRN working paper #6979178.

Conference Presentations and Invited Seminars

2026: ASSA Meeting; Next Generation of Antitrust Conference; Utah Antitrust Summit; NBER Law & Economics Spring Meeting; Utah Winter Strategy Conference; IIOC; EIEF; Oxera; Equitable Growth Seminar; BU Platform Strategy Symposium (PhD Consortium Discussant); Academy of Management; EARIE; Boston University; Stigler Fellows Conference at University of Chicago Booth; HSR at 50 Conference at Georgetown (Schedued); Harvard Business School–Strategy (Scheduled); FTC Annual Microeconomics Conference (Scheduled); NBER Place-Based Policies and Entrepreneurship (Discussant, Scheduled); CEPR Industrial Organization–Paris Symposium (Scheduled); Unibg IO Winter Symposium (Scheduled)

2025: Unibg IO Winter Symposium; Antitrust Merger Platform Policy Roundtable; Annual National Tax Association Conference (Discussant); BU IO Seminar; CRESSE (Presenter and Discussant); BSE Summer Forum; EAYE Annual Conference; IIOC (Presenter and Discussant); NBER Productivity Seminar; Digital Business Institute Research Showcase, Boston University; BYU/USC Winter Antitrust Conference

2024: Harvard-Oxford Conference on Common Ownership; Southern Economic Association Annual Conference; Digital Platforms Symposium at USC Marshall; 51st Annual Conference of EARIE; BSE Summer Forum (Economics of Science and Innovation); DRUID; University of Maryland Smith School of Business; USC Gould School of Law

2023: Boston University, Questrom School of Business; University of Toronto, Rotman School of Management; ESADE Business School; Universitat Pompeu Fabra; Universidad Carlos III de Madrid; Georgia Institute of Technology, Scheller College of Business; WEFI Student Workshop; University of Maryland (Dept. of Economics); University of Maryland Smith School of Business (Finance); University of Maryland Smith School of Business (Strategy); WEFI Student Workshop; NFI-NBIM-Oxford Conference on Common Ownership (Discussant)

2022: NBER Conference on Megafirms and the Post-COVID Economy; 23rd ACM Conference on Economics & Computation; Urban Economics Association North American Meeting; Conference on The Business Revolution of Digital Transformation at USC; GMU Law&Economics Center Research Roundtable on The Data-Competition Interface; 5th International Conference of China Development Studies

2021: IIOC Rising Stars; MACCI Annual Conference

Grants, Honors and Awards

Mehrotra Institute's Research Grant ($20,000, PI) 2026
Project: "Antitrust Beyond Prices"

International Center for Law & Economics Research Grant ($60,000, Co-PI) 2025
Project: "Post-Acquisition Career Paths of Founders in the Digital Economy"

Finalist 2024 Antitrust Writing Awards: Academic Articles, Mergers 2024
Concurrences

University of Maryland BSOS Dean's Research Initiative 2023
Travel Grant ($1,000)

Washington Center for Equitable Growth Doctoral Grant ($15,000, PI) 2022
Project: "Startups' Common Ownership and Competition in Technology Markets"

Program on Economics and Privacy at GMU Research Grant ($7,000) 2022
Project: "How Do Top Acquirers Compare in Technology Mergers?"

University of Maryland Faculty-Student Research Award 2022
Research Grant ($10,000), with Ginger Zhe Jin

Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant 2022
University of Maryland

Best Third Year Paper Award (2nd prize) 2021
Department of Economics, University of Maryland

University of Maryland Graduate School Summer Research Fellowship 2021
Stipend to support research activities ($5,000)

University of Maryland BSOS Dean's Research Initiative 2020, 2021
Research Grants ($1,500 and $3,248, respectively)

Graduate Research Assistantship 2021-2023
Department of Economics, University of Maryland

Graduate Teaching Assistantship 2019-2021
Department of Economics, University of Maryland

First-year Graduate Fellowship 2018-2019
Department of Economics, University of Maryland

Teaching

Entrepreneurial Strategy 2026
MBA elective, Boston University

Strategy, Innovation, and Global Competition 2025-2026
Undergraduate, Boston University

Research Seminar in Technology Strategy and Innovation 2025
Ph.D., Boston University

Intermediate Microeconomics 2020-2021
Undergraduate, University of Maryland

University and Department Service

Doctoral Advising and Committees
Zeyang Xue (Boston University, Committee Member, current)

Master Students and Past Research Assistants
Rayna Yang (Placement: Boston University, PhD in Information Systems)
Daling Shi (Placement: University of Miami, PhD in Biomedical Informatics)

Co-organizer of the Doctoral Consortium of the Platform Strategy Symposium 2026
Boston University

Organizer of the Strategy & Innovation Research Seminar 2025-
Boston University

Organizer of the Industrial Organization Seminar 2024-
Boston University

Strategy & Innovation Department, Search committee for Assistant Professor 2024-2025
Boston University

Member of the Academic Conduct Committee 2024-2025
Boston University

Professional Service

Referee for: *Applied Economics Letters*, *DRUID Annual Conference*, *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, *Journal of Regional Science*, *Metroeconomica*, *RAND Journal of Economics*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *Strategic Management Society Annual Conference*

Young Economist Representative of the Transportation and Energy Committee — 2022-2023
American Bar Association

Economics Ambassador — 2021-2022
American Bar Association

Additional Experience

NBER Entrepreneurship Research Bootcamp — 2023
Summer school in Entrepreneurship & Innovation

Research Assistant for Ginger Zhe Jin — 2022-2023
University of Maryland

Research Assistant for Andrew Sweeting — 2021-2022
University of Maryland

NBER Digitization Tutorial — 2021
Additional classes in Digital Economics

Research Assistant for Marco Ottaviani — 2017
Bocconi University

Research Assistant at LEAR — 2018
Economic Consulting

IGIER Visiting Student — 2015-2016
Bocconi University

Skills & Languages

Languages: English (Fluent), Italian (Native), Spanish (Beginner)
Programming: Stata, MATLAB, R, Mathematica, Python, oTree, Latex

Last updated: October 23, 2026.